

Assessment	Test	Domain	Skill	Difficulty
SAT	Math	Geometry and Trigonometry	Circles	Hard

Question

Circle A has equation $(x - 7)^2 + (y + 3)^2 = 1$. In the xy -plane, circle B is obtained by translating circle A to the right **4** units. Which equation represents circle B?

Answer

- A. $(x - 7)^2 + (y + 7)^2 = 1$
- B. $(x - 3)^2 + (y + 3)^2 = 1$
- C. $(x - 11)^2 + (y + 3)^2 = 1$
- D. $(x - 7)^2 + (y - 1)^2 = 1$

Correct Answer: C

Rationale

Choice C is correct. The equation of a circle in the xy -plane can be written as $(x - h)^2 + (y - k)^2 = r^2$, where the center of the circle is (h, k) and the radius of the circle is r units. It's given that circle A has the equation $(x - 7)^2 + (y + 3)^2 = 1$, which can be written as $(x - 7)^2 + (y - (-3))^2 = 1^2$. It follows that $h = 7$, $k = -3$, and $r = 1$. Therefore, the center of circle A is $(7, -3)$ and its radius is **1** unit. If circle A is translated **4** units to the right, the x -coordinate of the center will increase by **4**, while the y -coordinate and the radius of the circle will remain unchanged. Translating the center of circle A to the right **4** units yields $(7 + 4, -3)$, or $(11, -3)$. Therefore, the center of circle B is $(11, -3)$. Substituting **11** for h , -3 for k , and **1** for r into the equation $(x - h)^2 + (y - k)^2 = r^2$ yields $(x - 11)^2 + (y - (-3))^2 = 1$, or $(x - 11)^2 + (y + 3)^2 = 1$. Therefore, the equation $(x - 11)^2 + (y + 3)^2 = 1$ represents circle B.

Choice A is incorrect. This equation represents a circle obtained by shifting circle A down, rather than right, **4** units.

Choice B is incorrect. This equation represents a circle obtained by shifting circle A left, rather than right, **4** units.

Choice D is incorrect. This equation represents a circle obtained by shifting circle A up, rather than right, **4** units.